

Marla Sowards

AI-fluent content engineer

Salt Lake City, Utah | marlasowards@gmail.com | 801-836-8804 | [LinkedIn](#) | [Github](#) | marlasowards.com

Experience

Verifiable | Austin, Texas (Remote)

Lead Technical Writer | 2024 - 2026

- Stood up the company's first help content ecosystem by creating ~20 product guides with ~500 help articles and sets of release notes plus external and internal channels of communication, prioritizing work by aligning with executive priorities, partnering cross-functionally to develop content that met end users' needs, and centering efforts on work that delivered measurable value
- Built custom MCPs and AI agent skills to ingest product knowledge (code in product repos, Jira tickets, Zendesk tickets, Confluence and Notion pages, roadmaps, etc.), draft and validate AI-optimized product help content, facilitate human-in-the-loop reviews, and deliver the content to end users via a help site and Claude AI connection
- Used an XML-based CCMS to manage content, leveraging single sourcing and structured reuse to scale content across multiple products and releases
- Built a custom-themed Zendesk help site with a taxonomy-based information architecture that optimized AI search results and ticket deflection through suggested articles
- Architected a conversational AI chatbot that responded to prompts with answers scoped to the user's own platform and software version
- Created AI agent skills that analyzed support tickets for common issues and resolutions and drafted troubleshooting articles, FAQs, cheatsheets, and reference material to deflect tickets
- Built MCP API wrappers and AI agent skills that programmatically interacted with CMS tools through natural language prompts, reducing time spent performing repetitive actions in UIs
- Performed AI analysis on data joined from Google Analytics and native reporting in CSM tools, providing leadership detailed views of customer usage patterns across content touchpoints

Health Catalyst | Salt Lake City, Utah

Senior Technical Writer | 2019 - 2023

- Wrote and managed product enablement content aligned with a software release cadence, including user guides, install guides, administration guides, reference guides, help articles, release notes, and customer communications
- Built a customer help site for a suite of healthcare data applications by implementing a docs-as-code ecosystem (Markdown stored in Git repos, transformed to HTML using an open-source static-site generator, and deployed to production via automated deployment pipelines), resulting in a help site that operated with very low overhead
- Published friendly, easy-to-reference guides and offered 1:1 coaching to help contributors painlessly understand and participate in docs-as-code Git workflows
- Built a REST and .NET API documentation portal, including overviews, tutorials, and reference documentation

- Developed personas through user research and data in collaboration with UX designers, PMs, support, operations, and customer success
- Developed and published analytics dashboards that dug deep into customer usage patterns, providing actionable insights across customer journey touchpoints

Technical Writer | 2017 - 2019

- Built a one-stop destination for customer success team members to track product development frictionlessly through sprint demo summaries, roadmap presentations, and release planning session recordings, find enablement resources, and share input and feedback with PMs
- Built and facilitated online customer communities in Verint and Jive with help articles, release notes, videos, Q&A, blog posts, and feature requests
- Governed the end-to-end content lifecycle, including content additions, audits, maintenance mechanisms, tracking processes, and timelines
- Scoped documentation needs by tracking requirements, specifications, epics, and user stories
- Developed personas through user research and data in collaboration with UX designers, PMs, support, operations, and customer success

Technical Editor | 2014 - 2017

- Edited hundreds of pages for spelling, grammar, and accuracy, also creating and applying style and usage guides, templates, and branding standards to enforce a high standard of quality and consistency across product enablement content
- Validated documentation accuracy through hands-on testing across software products
- Designed, created, and maintained internal product knowledge bases in SharePoint and Jive CMS

my529 | Salt Lake City, Utah

Senior Writer | 2010 - 2014

- Wrote and edited customer communications, internal documentation, and outreach materials
- Partnered with subject matter experts to make complex financial and technical information easy to access and understand
- Collaborated with executive leadership and managers to identify and meet audiences' needs
- Evaluated, proposed, and implemented new technologies for creating and distributing content
- Maintained brand voice by curating an in-house style and usage guide and lightweight homegrown CMS

Education

- Technical and Professional Writing, M.S. | Utah State University
- Print Journalism, B.A. | Brigham Young University

Tools and skills

AI and automation

- **AI assistants:** Claude (Chat, Cowork, Code), ChatGPT, Gemini Gems, Zendesk AI Agent
- **AI development:** Custom Claude MCP servers, AI agent skills

- **Workflow automation:** Claude scheduled tasks, Azure Functions, Azure Logic Apps, Google Cloud Functions, Microsoft Power Automate

Documentation

- **Methods:** Docs-as-code, structured authoring, Diátaxis framework
- **Tools:** Markdown, Paligo XML CCMS, static-site generators
- **Content platforms:** Zendesk, Confluence, Notion, SharePoint, Verint, Jive

Development

- **Languages:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript (basic), Bash
- **Templating:** Mustache, Handlebars
- **Version control and deployment:** Git, GitHub, automated deployment pipelines
- **APIs and tools:** REST APIs, Postman, Visual Studio Code

Analytics

- Amazon QuickSight, Azure Application Insights and Workbooks, Google Analytics, Microsoft Power BI, built-in CMS reporting

Collaboration and project tracking

- Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, Slack, Azure DevOps, Jira